Louis Andrada

Born in 2002 in Mossoró, Brazil
Resides and works in Toronto, Canada

Contact Information

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Exhibitions

2026 — Group Exhibition — Pancakes and Booze — Toronto, Canada
2024-2025 — Works on Display — The Chess Gallery — Toronto, Canada

Press & Publications

2026 — Featured Artworks — ArtLaunch — Canada/Online

Collections

Private:
- Athens, Greece
- Rapid City, USA
- Suncheon, South Korea
- Toronto, Canada

Artistic Practice

Acrylic painting practice informed by analog photography and darkroom methodologies. Visual language built through tonal fragmentation, simulated grain, and controlled image degradation translated into paint.

Technical Background

Analog film photography (foundation); Darkroom printing processes (conceptual and technical influence); Application of photographic structures and exposure logic within acrylic painting.

Louis Andrada — Description of Practice

Louis Andrada is a Toronto-based painter whose practice is rooted in the translation of analog photographic processes into acrylic painting. His earlier training in film photography and darkroom production established a technical and conceptual framework that continues to inform his current work. Rather than producing photographs, Andrada reconstructs photographic phenomena through paint, developing images that appear exposed, degraded, and chemically altered. His previous work focused on understanding tonal range, contrast control, and image structure through analog methods. This foundation now operates within his painting practice, where these same principles are reinterpreted materially.

His current work is centered on fragmentation, instability, and controlled deterioration of the image. Surfaces are built in layers that simulate grain, half-tone breakdown, and disrupted resolution. Figures and forms emerge gradually, often resisting full clarity, existing in a state between visibility and collapse. The paintings function as constructed images rather than direct representations, maintaining a tension between precision and decay.

The work is driven by internal imagery associated with fear, unease, and psychological disturbance. Drawing from horror, folklore, and occult visual traditions, Andrada does not prioritize narrative but instead focuses on isolating moments of tension or threat. Painting operates as a containment mechanism, forcing unstable or intrusive images into a fixed, material state. This approach positions the work within a broader lineage of image-making concerned with perception, distortion, and the limits of visibility.

Technically, the practice requires controlled studio conditions for layered acrylic application and drying time between stages. Works are developed through sequential layering, with each stage dependent on the stability of the previous surface. There are no complex installation requirements; paintings are presented as wall-mounted works. Production timelines vary depending on scale and complexity, but each piece typically requires multiple sessions over an extended period to achieve the desired level of surface control and image degradation.

Louis Andrada — Support Material – Digital Images (10 Works)

I. *A Man Mourning Its Lack of Purpose*, 2026
39 x 26 in
Acrylic on canvas

II. *A Lover's Gasp*, 2026
61 × 45 in
Acrylic on canvas

III. *Another Lost One*, 2026
28 × 62 in
Acrylic on canvas

IV. *Ballad of Lost Dreams*, 2026
62 × 47 in
Acrylic on canvas

V. *Despair*, 2026
71 × 43 in
Acrylic on canvas

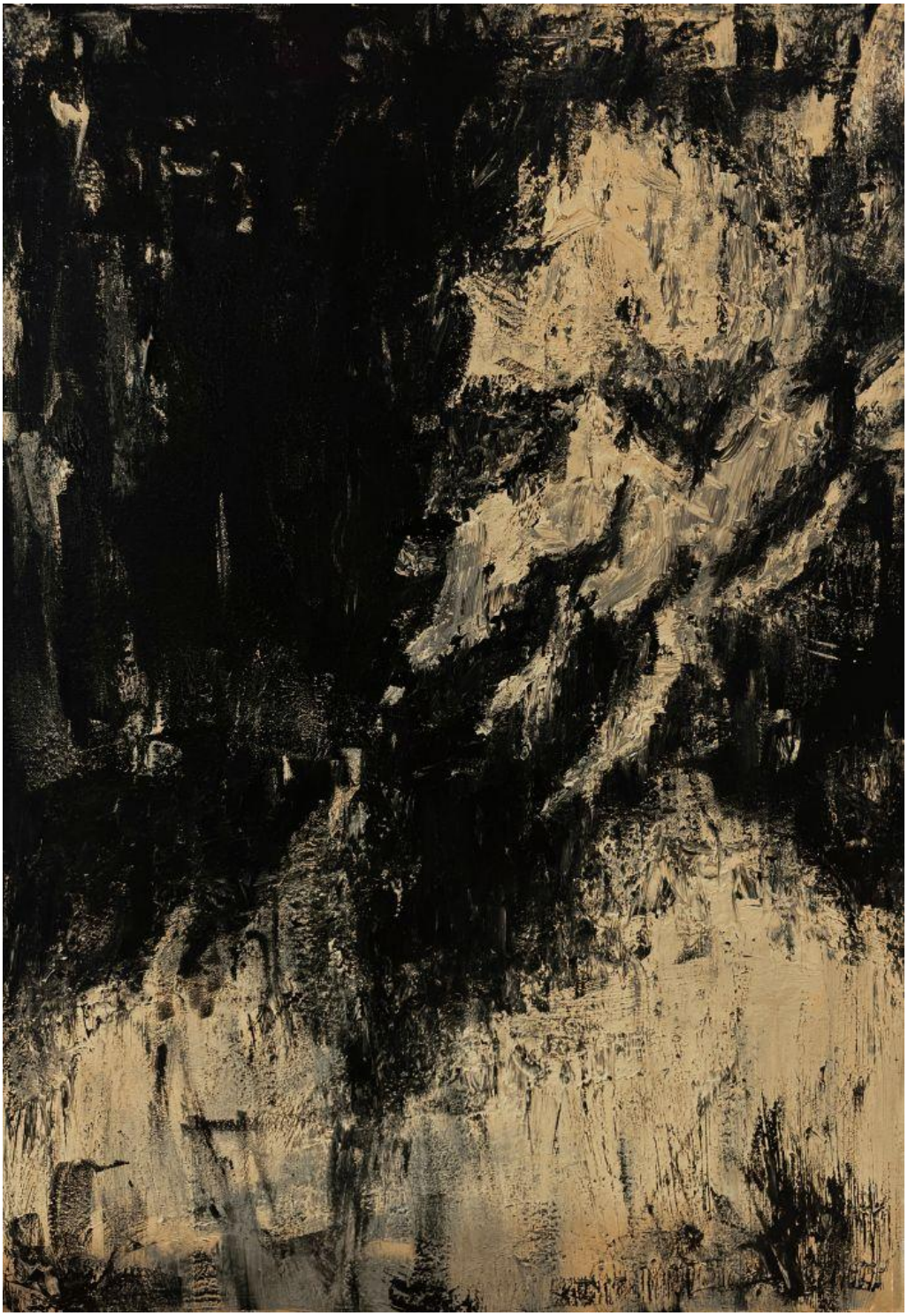
VI. *Jogo da Forca*, 2026
30 × 40 in
Acrylic on canvas

VII. *Blood Path*, 2026
24 × 12 in
Acrylic on canvas with wood frame

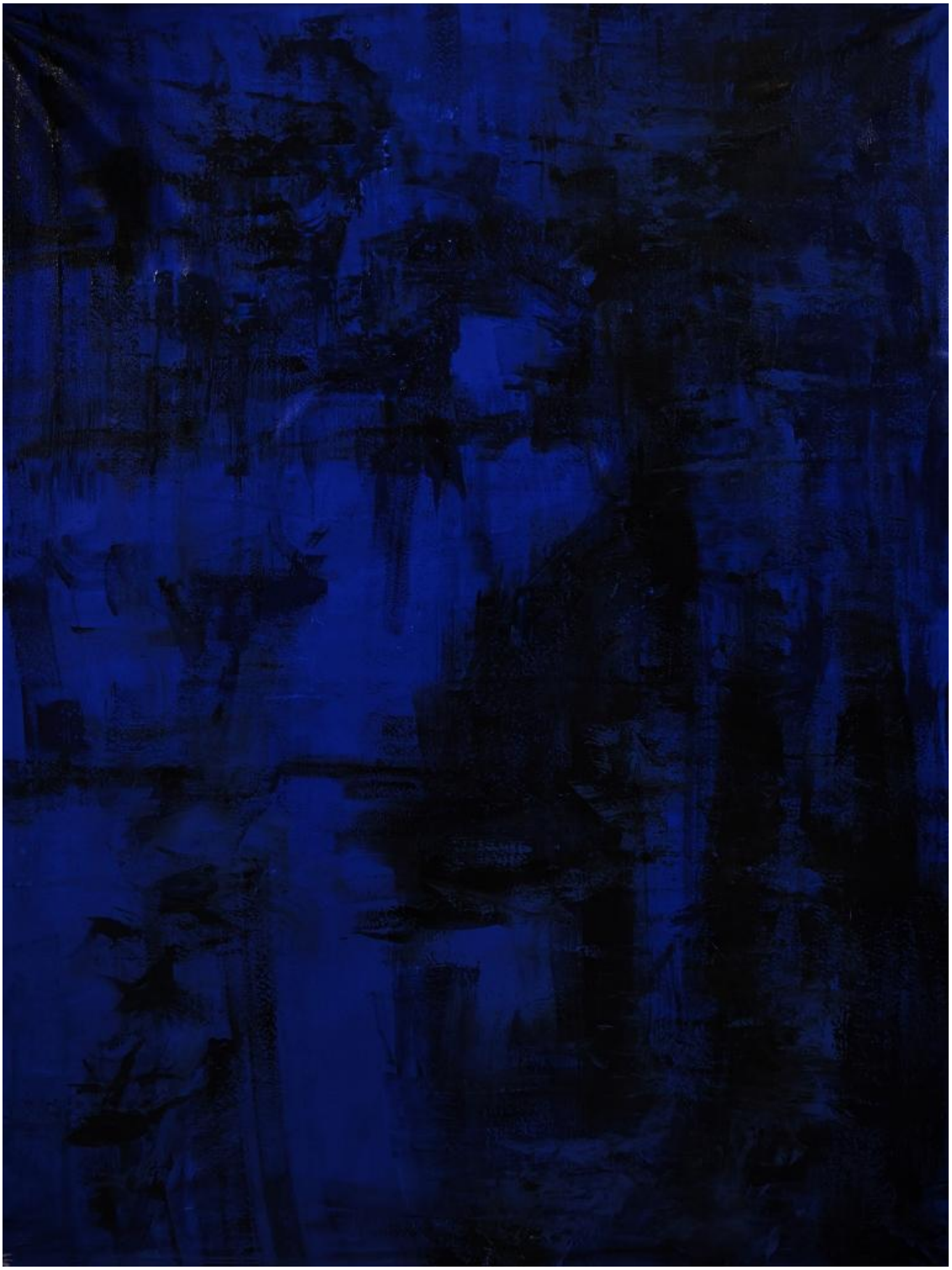
VIII. *Subject N.5*, 2026
71 × 43 in
Acrylic on canvas

IX. *Subject N.2*, 2026
28 × 22 in
Acrylic on canvas

X. *Card N.XV*, 2025
36 × 24 in
Mixed media on cardboard



A Man Mourning Its Lack of Purpose, 2026 I
39 x 26 in
Acrylic on canvas



A Lover's Gasp, 2026 II
61 × 45 in
Acrylic on canvas

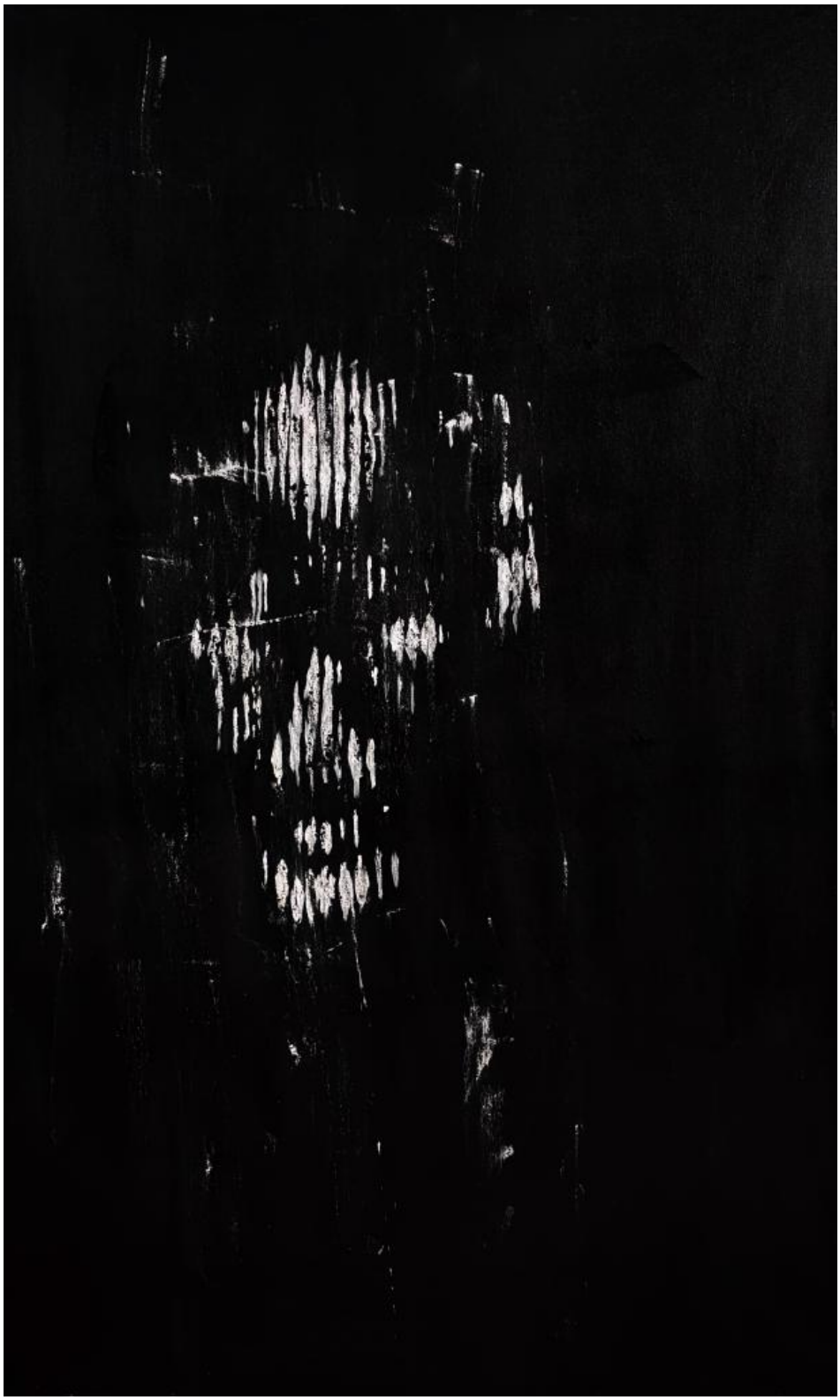
Another Lost One, 2026 III
28 × 62 in
Acrylic on canvas

Ballad of Lost Dreams, 2026 IV
62 × 47 in
Acrylic on canvas

Despair, 2026 V
71 × 43 in
Acrylic on canvas

Jogo da Forca, 2026 VI
30 × 40 in
Acrylic on canvas

Blood Path, 2026 VII
24 × 12 in
Acrylic on canvas with wood frame



Subject N.5, 2026 VIII
71 × 43 in
Acrylic on canvas

Subject N.2, 2026 IX
28 × 22 in
Acrylic on canvas

Card N.XV, 2025 X
36 × 24 in
Mixed media on cardboard